

Thinking about careers

When researching the roles and industries that appeal to them, teens should also consider the qualifications and experience that future employers might be looking for, as well as what opportunities are available. This can help them make a decision about what subjects to study at school or college, and what work experience opportunities to pursue.

GOOD TO KNOW

Changing careers

It was once common for someone to stay in the same career for their entire working life, but now it's much more normal for people to move around and change industries. This can happen when people develop new interests and skills, or face changes in the job market that create new jobs or cause older jobs to disappear.



Qualifications

It's worthwhile investigating what educational qualifications are required to work in certain areas. Some job areas require people to have studied certain subjects or to have a degree.



Experience

Most jobs require some previous experience. When starting out, the best way to gain experience is through completing an apprenticeship or volunteering.

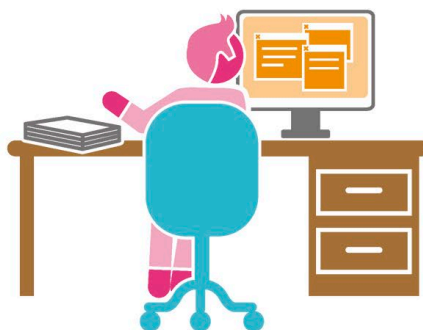


Opportunities available

The working world can be very competitive. Knowing in advance how likely they are to be able to secure work and develop skills in the future, may be a factor in a teen's thought process.

Work experience

To get a sense of what might appeal, teens can get a taste for different roles through apprenticeships or internships. These opportunities give teens the chance to show enthusiasm, interest, and willingness to potential future employers and to get great experience for their resume, as well as insight into the working world.



▷ Learning on the job

Apprenticeships and internships also give teens the chance to experience what working environments suit them best.

TEEN HINTS

Getting work experience

One way to get an apprenticeship is to approach people in your family or community who work in industries that interest you. Alternatively, if your school has one, ask your career adviser if they have any contacts that they can pass on to you. Finally, try contacting companies directly to ask about any opportunities they have available.